THE SHE LIST UNDER 50

THE **ENTREPRENEURS**

Lab to Landmark

WHAT MAKES HER A SHERO

Ameera transformed Metropolis from a single laboratory in Mumbai into India's second-largest diagnostics chain, and champions women entrepreneurs

When Ameera Shah joined her father's pathology practice in 2001, it was still a doctor-led business built from a single laboratory in Mumbai. Shah, a finance graduate from the University of Texas at Austin, began in customer service, learning the business from the ground up. Over the next two decades, she transformed it into Metropolis Healthcare, currently India's second-largest diagnostics chain, operating across more than 750 towns. Along the way, she raised three rounds of private equity and took the company public in 2019. In FY26, group revenue grew 23.6 per cent to Rs 1,646 crore.

The past couple of years, however, have seen Shah step back to focus on more strategic decisions. In 2024, she moved from managing director to executive chairperson. "There were years when I worked 15-16 hours a day," Shah recalls. "Stepping back was difficult, but I felt that what the company needed from me now was different." Her job, she says, is increasingly to provide direction for the next chapter. "When a company is as old as Metropolis, you have to keep innovating."

That vision is already visible. Metropolis has been pushing deeper into genomics, next-generation sequencing and specialised diagnostics, while expanding through three acquisitions—Core Diagnostics in Delhi-NCR, Scientific Pathology in Agra and Dr Ahuja's Pathology & Imaging Centre in Dehradun.

AMEERA SHAH, 46
Executive Chairperson, Metropolis Healthcare Ltd
Mumbai

Stepping away has also made room for a life beyond the laboratory. Shah has many interests—tennis, trekking and sailing, learning Kathak and being an enthusiastic reader. There is also another pursuit increasingly competing for her attention: creating opportunities for other women. As co-founder and chair of women's entrepreneurship at the Udaiti Foundation, Shah has been working since April 2025 to get more Indian women into the workforce and help women-led businesses grow. The foundation, set up in 2002, uses data, policy and partnerships to address the barriers that prevent women from participating fully in the economy.

For Shah, those barriers often begin long before a woman enters an office. Metropolis, where around 44 per cent of the workforce is female, has given her a place to put some of her thinking into practice. Education, however, is what she believes is the starting point. "Women also need the confidence to use it," she says, recalling a time when she introduced herself as a businesswoman only to hear, "But why do you work when you are so pretty?" That is the mindset her work promoting young women to start and lead their businesses is striving to change. ■

— Sonali Acharjee

HER TAKE

"A working woman is still not mainstream in India. Girls get great degrees, sometimes only as part of marriage negotiations. We need women to be educated, but also bold enough to pursue their professional ambitions"

Photograph by **MANDAR DEODHAR**